

Vox Populi on CachyOS

Civilization V + Vox Populi via Steam and Proton

Revision 9.0.6 · 2026-09-22 · Vox Populi 5.4.6 (stable) · Protontricks 1.14.1-1 · Proton 11.0 · CachyOS with native Steam; other distributions in §3.

Every command block below is fish, the default login shell on CachyOS. In bash or zsh, translate these five constructs:

fish	bash / zsh
set -g NAME "value"	NAME="value"
set NAME (command)	NAME="\$(command)"
cmd; and other	cmd && other
test -d x; and A; or B	if [-d x]; then A; else B; fi
for x in a b; ...; end	for x in a b; do ...; done

Blocks tagged fish are commands; untagged blocks are tables and paths. Every step that writes to disk ends in a check you can run; the two wizard steps, 6 and 7, are checked by Step 8. WARNING marks a common failure, CRITICAL a step that decides whether this works at all.

The same guide is also here as vox-populi-cachyos.pdf (print-ready, US Letter) and vox-populi-cachyos-print.html.

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1. How it works

Proton is mandatory. Vox Populi ships a compiled Windows game-core DLL that the native Aspyr Linux build cannot load; the Windows build under Proton is the only working configuration.

The installer is Inno Setup 6 (Installer Version 1.2), a plain Win32 wizard that renders correctly under Proton; no .NET is involved.

It asks for two different paths.

Wizard page	Resolves to	Receives
Select Destination Location – the Documents path LEAVE THIS ALONE	{userdocs}\My Games\ Sid Meier's Civilization 5 Under Proton: C:\users\steamuser\ Documents\... (in the prefix)	MODS\ (1) Community Patch MODS\ (2) Vox Populi MODS\ (3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files MODS\ (3b) 43 Civs Community Patch MODS\ (4a) Squads for VP MODS\ (5) Modpack Maker for VP Text\VPUI_tips_en_us.xml
Select the Civilization V folder – custom page, right after the setup-type page THIS IS THE ONE THAT GOES WRONG	Whatever you browse to. Must be the REAL game install, reached through Z:\ (Wine maps Z: to /)	Assets\DLC\VPUI Assets\DLC\UI_bc1 (EUI only) Assets\DLC\Expansion2\ Expansion2.Civ5Pkg (replaced) Assets\DLC\Expansion2\Sounds\ XML\ MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml

The Documents default is already correct: it resolves inside the prefix, where the Windows build reads mods. The Civilization V folder page fills itself in only when a Windows-style Steam path exists inside the prefix; on a clean prefix it arrives blank.

CRITICAL — Aim that page at the real Linux install and nothing needs copying. The wizard refuses a folder without Assets\DLC and all ten DLC folders, so on a clean prefix a wrong path is blocked, not installed. A game tree already inside the prefix — a copied install, say — passes that test, and the UI assets land where the game never reads them; that is why some guides need a copy step.

Every DLC must be installed, not merely owned. The wizard blocks unless DLC_01–DLC_07, DLC_Deluxe (Babylon), Expansion (Gods & Kings) and Expansion2 (Brave New World) all exist — in practice the Complete Edition on Civ V 1.0.3.279.

It cleans up after itself. Before writing it deletes the prefix cache, the current VP mod folders and the legacy CBP/CBO/CSD folders. Clear nothing by hand, and expect any edit inside a VP mod folder to be lost at the next install or update.

There is no uninstaller entry (Uninstallable=no). Removal is the **Uninstall all** setup type in the same .exe.

Stable and beta releases both exist. Each GitHub release links a release-notes thread titled *New STABLE Version* or *New BETA Version*. 5.4.6 (2026-08-31) is stable.

2. Requirements

Game	Civilization V 1.0.3.279, all expansions and all DLC installed
Steam	Native Steam (multilib steam); data dir ~/.local/share/Steam, also reachable through ~/.steam/root. Other distributions: §3
Compat tool	Proton Experimental or newest numbered Proton (11.0 at this revision); proton-cachyos-slr OK. NOT "Steam Linux Runtime" – that is not Proton
Tooling	extra/protontricks 1.14.1-1 – pulls winetricks, which pulls wine and cabextract; yad and zenity for the GUIs; ripgrep, rsync, zip for this guide's own checks and backups
Disk	Full re-download of the Windows depots, plus ~105 MB installer
Conflicts	No Workshop subscriptions to Community Patch, More Luxuries, City-State Diplomacy, Civ IV Diplomatic Features; no mod shipping its own DLL

Set these once per terminal session; every command below uses them. `set -g` dies with the shell: in a new terminal run the four lines again, or the `rm -rf` lines in §8, §10 and §12 find nothing — §8 and §12 print `STOP` first, §10 says nothing.

```
set -g CIV5_LIB "$HOME/.local/share/Steam"
set -g CIV5_GAME "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V"
set -g CIV5_PFX "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/drive_c"
set -g CIV5_DOCS "$CIV5_PFX/users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/Sid Meier's Civilization 5"
```

`CIV5_LIB` is the Steam library that holds Civ V — above, native Steam's default on CachyOS; §3 lists other packagings. `compatdata/8930` always sits in the same library as the game. If Civ V is in a secondary library, print the one that holds it:

```
rg -o '"path"\s+"([^\"]+)"' -r '${1}/steamapps/appmanifest_8930.acf' \
"$HOME/.steam/root/steamapps/libraryfolders.vdf" | xargs -r -d '\n' ls 2>/dev/null
```

`rg` (ripgrep) ships with CachyOS; on plain Arch run the Step 4 package line first. The line works unchanged in bash and prints the `appmanifest_8930.acf` of the library that holds Civ V: set `CIV5_LIB` to the part before `/steamapps` and re-run all four lines, since the other three are built from it. Flatpak and Snap Steam keep `libraryfolders.vdf` under their own directory from §3, not `~/.steam/root`.

3. Other distributions

From Step 1 on, only the Step 4 package command is CachyOS-specific. Three things differ elsewhere — how Steam is installed, where its default library sits (`CIV5_LIB`), and whether the distribution's own Protontricks is recent enough. **Protontricks 1.12.0 is the floor**: older releases cannot read the current Steam client's `appinfo.vdf` and stop with "Invalid file magic number".

Distribution	Steam	Protontricks
CachyOS, Arch	steam (multilib)	extra, 1.14.1 – Step 4
Ubuntu 26.04 LTS	steam-installer (multiverse)	multiverse, 1.13.1 – use it
Ubuntu 24.04 LTS	steam-installer (multiverse)	multiverse, 1.10.5 – too old; use the Flatpak
Debian 13	steam-installer (contrib)	none in trixie; use the Flatpak
Fedora 44	steam (RPM Fusion Nonfree)	fedora, 1.14.0 – use it
Steam Deck	preinstalled	Flatpak, from Discover

Where the default library sits — the value for CIV5_LIB unless Civ V lives in a secondary library:

Steam packaging	CIV5_LIB for the default library
Native package, any distro Arch, CachyOS Debian, Ubuntu	whatever realpath ~/.steam/root prints ~/.local/share/Steam ~/.steam/debian-installation for a new install; older installs may sit in ~/.local/share/Steam
Flatpak Steam Snap Steam	~/.var/app/com.valvesoftware.Steam/.local/share/Steam ~/snap/steam/common/.local/share/Steam

Ubuntu 26.04 LTS — everything comes from the archive:

```
sudo dpkg --add-architecture i386
sudo add-apt-repository multiverse
sudo apt update
sudo apt install steam-installer protontricks yad cabextract ripgrep rsync zip curl
```

Ubuntu 24.04 LTS — its Protontricks is too old, so the Flatpak replaces it:

```
sudo dpkg --add-architecture i386
sudo add-apt-repository multiverse
sudo apt update
sudo apt install steam-installer flatpak ripgrep rsync zip curl
flatpak remote-add --if-not-exists flathub https://dl.flathub.org/repo/flathub.flatpakrepo
```

Debian 13 — first add contrib to the components of your trixie APT sources, as the Debian wiki's Steam page shows:

```
sudo dpkg --add-architecture i386
sudo apt update
sudo apt install steam-installer mesa-vulkan-drivers \
    libglx-mesa0:i386 mesa-vulkan-drivers:i386 libgl1-mesa-dri:i386
sudo apt install flatpak ripgrep rsync zip curl
flatpak remote-add --if-not-exists flathub https://dl.flathub.org/repo/flathub.flatpakrepo
```

The Mesa packages are the wiki's list for Vulkan and 32-bit titles and serve the open-source AMD and Intel drivers. With NVIDIA's proprietary driver, install its 32-bit libraries instead: `sudo apt install nvidia-driver-libs:i386`.

Fedora 44 — Steam comes from RPM Fusion Nonfree, Protontricks from Fedora itself. In bash, write `$(rpm -E %fedora)`:

```
sudo dnf install \
    https://mirrors.rpmfusion.org/nonfree/fedora/rpmfusion-nonfree-release-(rpm -E %fedora).noarch.rpm
sudo dnf install steam protontricks yad cabextract ripgrep rsync zip
```

Steam Deck — in Desktop Mode install Protontricks from Discover, as upstream recommends. SteamOS's root is read-only, so nothing is added with pacman; substitute for a missing tool — `grep -i` for `rg -i`, for example.

Then, on any of them:

1. If you just added Flathub, restart first.
2. With the Flatpak (Ubuntu 24.04, Debian 13, Steam Deck), install Protontricks from the Flatpak block in Step 4, aliases included.
3. Start Steam once and sign in, so it creates its directories.

4. Set CIV5_LIB in §2 from the second table — inside the quotes, write ~ as \$HOME — and re-run all four lines.

```
realpath ~/.steam/root
protontricks --version
```

Check: the first line prints your Steam directory (native packages only), the second 1.12.0 or newer. Continue with Step 1.

4. Stage A — game under Proton

Step 1 · Force Proton

Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **Compatibility** → tick **Force the use of a specific Steam Play compatibility tool** → Proton Experimental or the newest numbered Proton. Steam swaps the native build for the Windows depots; let it finish. If the download stops with a disk write error, see §13.

WARNING — The same dropdown lists Steam Linux Runtime entries. They are not Proton: no Wine prefix is created, and protontricks-launch stops with "Proton installation could not be found!".

CachyOS alternatives (install, restart Steam): proton-cachyos-slr, proton-cachyos-native, or protonup-qt / protonplus for Proton-GE. Prefer -slr — a Proton build that runs inside the Steam Linux Runtime container, not one of the bare *Steam Linux Runtime* entries above.

S: drive: Proton 11.0 and Experimental map S: to the game's Steam library for every game; on Proton 10.0 or older the launch option PROTON_SET_GAME_DRIVE=1 %command% does the same. It shortens the browse in Step 7. After Step 3, `ls -l "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/dosdevices"` should show s: pointing at the library root, the folder that holds steamapps. If that root is not writable or is on another filesystem, Proton points s: at steamapps itself and the wizard path becomes S:\common\...; with no s: at all, use the Z: path.

Check: once Steam finishes, the game folder holds the Windows build:

```
find "$CIV5_GAME" -maxdepth 1 -iname '*.exe'
```

It lists CivilizationV_DX11.exe among others. No output means Steam is still serving the native build, whose binary is Civ5XP.

Step 2 · Confirm every DLC

Steam → Properties → **DLC** → tick everything, then:

```
for d in DLC_01 DLC_02 DLC_03 DLC_04 DLC_05 DLC_06 DLC_07 DLC_Deluxe Expansion Expansion2
do
  test -d "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/$d"; and echo "ok $d"; or echo "MISS $d"
end
```

Check: ten ok lines. Any MISS stops the installer at Step 7.

Step 3 · Launch once, reach the main menu, quit

This creates compatdata/8930/pfx, without which Protontricks cannot see the game, and builds Civ V's Documents tree inside it. If the Firaxis launcher appears, choose DirectX 10/11; the DX9 executable may start regardless (Proton #8327), which does not affect Vox Populi.

Check:

```
ls "$CIV5_PFX"      # Program Files, Program Files (x86), users, windows
ls "$CIV5_DOCS"     # expect Logs, Saves, config.ini among others
```

5. Stage B — install Vox Populi

Step 4 · Protontricks and runtime libraries

```
sudo pacman -S --needed protontricks yad zenity ripgrep rsync zip
protontricks --version
protontricks -s civilization
```

Check: the version is 1.12.0 or newer, and the search prints Sid Meier's Civilization V with app ID **8930**. Nothing printed means Step 3 did not complete. Other distributions install Protontricks as §3 describes.

Flatpak Protontricks, or Flatpak Steam (alternative)

```
flatpak install flathub com.github.Matoking.protontricks
flatpak override --user "--filesystem=$HOME/Downloads" com.github.Matoking.protontricks
# one --filesystem= override per Steam library outside the default location
alias --save protontricks 'flatpak run com.github.Matoking.protontricks'
alias --save protontricks-launch 'flatpak run --command=protontricks-launch com.github.Matoking.protontricks'
```

The two aliases let every later command run unchanged; in bash, add the Protontricks README's two alias lines to ~/.bashrc instead (alias --save is fish-only). Flatpak Protontricks sees only the Steam directory: without an override covering the .exe, it says it "does not appear to have access to the following directories" and prints the flatpak override command to run. If *Steam itself* is the Flatpak, every path in §17 moves under ~/.var/app/com.valvesoftware.Steam/.

Then install the Visual C++ 2008 runtime and Microsoft's core fonts into the game's prefix:

```
protontricks 8930 -q vcrun2008 corefonts
protontricks 8930 list-installed
```

Check: the list includes vcrun2008 and corefonts.

CvGameCore_Expansion2.dll (both 5.4.6 variants) imports MSVCR90.dll and MSVCP90.dll, the Visual C++ 2008 runtime that vcrun2008 installs; Wine's built-in copies usually suffice, but a report in thread 702075 had VP working only after this step. corefonts adds Microsoft's ten core web fonts and needs cabextract. Everything after the app ID goes to Winetricks, hence -q (unattended) there; installed verbs are skipped, so re-running is harmless. Both verbs download, so this needs network access.

Of the variables in that report's command, only PROTON_NO_FSYNC=1 matters: it turns off the fsync that Protontricks enables by default — put it in front if a verb hangs. WINEDEBUG=-all only quiets output, Protontricks sets WINEPREFIX itself, and nothing in the chain reads WINE_DISABLE_NICE.

Step 5 · Download and verify

Releases are GitHub assets on LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL, named Vox.Populi.<version>.exe.

```
mkdir -p "$HOME/Downloads"
set -g CIV5_SUM 31679423e55d7f64ba9693d8252d9e29f824fd9f8da043af547470068f98ba8a
curl -fL -o "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe" \
  https://github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/releases/download/Release-5.4.6/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe
echo "$CIV5_SUM $HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe" | sha256sum -c -
```

Check: the last line ends in OK. FAILED, or an error from curl, means delete the file and download it again; do not run it.

For other versions, put the digest from that release's asset listing into CIV5_SUM and confirm STABLE vs BETA in its release-notes thread title. Release_Debug.zip is a debug DLL for crash reports, not needed for play.

Step 6 · Run it inside the prefix

```
protontricks-launch --appid 8930 "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe"
```

GUI: right-click the .exe → **Open With** → **Protontricks Launcher** → Sid Meier's Civilization V.

Flatpak without the Step 4 aliases: flatpak run --command=protontricks-launch
com.github.Matoking.protontricks --appid 8930 <exe>

The wizard can take a minute to appear and may open behind other windows under Wayland. The 64-bit WINEPREFIX warning is expected: Civ V is 32-bit inside a 64-bit prefix.

Step 7 · Work the wizard

	Page	Action
★	License · Information	Next
★	Select Destination Location	LEAVE UNCHANGED. Must read C:\users\steamuser\Documents\My Games\Sid Meier's Civilization 5
★	Setup Type / Components	Choose one variant – table below
★	Select the Civilization V folder	Browse to S:\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V, or to the Z:\ path that the command under these tables prints
	Start Menu folder	May be skipped; irrelevant under Proton, Next
	Ready to Install	CHECK "Civilization V path" shows the S:\ or Z:\ path, not C:\Program Files (x86)\...
	Installing · Finished	Wait, Finish

Vox Populi (with EUI)	Full VP + Enhanced User Interface – the usual choice
Vox Populi (no EUI)	Full VP, stock interface
Community Patch only	AI and bugfix base mod. NOT compatible with EUI
43 Civ ... (three variants)	Same options with a DLL supporting 43 major civs
Uninstall all	Removal path – §12

The Z:\ form of your install, ready to type into the folder field:

```
echo "Z:$CIV5_GAME" | tr / "\\\\"
```

The line runs unchanged in bash. If the Ready page shows a C:\Program Files (x86) path, go back and fix it rather than copy files afterwards. The installer also fails if MODS has been moved out of the Documents tree, which under Proton only happens if you change the Documents page.

Step 8 · Verify placement

```
ls "$CIV5_DOCS/MODS" # (1)...(5) for your variant
ls "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC" | rg -i 'VPUI|UI_bc1' # VPUI, + UI_bc1 for EUI
ls "$CIV5_PFX/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V/Assets/DLC" 2>/dev/null
```

Check: the second command is the pass/fail test for Step 7: a Vox Populi variant shows VPUI, plus UI_bc1 with EUI; Community Patch only installs neither, so look for Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml under the same Assets/DLC. The third must print nothing — output means a game tree inside the prefix took the files. Re-run the installer with the correct path, or copy across:

```
rsync -a --dry-run \
  "$CIV5_PFX/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V/Assets/" \
  "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/"
```

Inspect, then re-run without --dry-run. There is no Assets/DLC/Vox Populi folder; the installer creates VPUI and, with EUI, UI_bc1.

6. Stage C — first run

1. Launch Civ V from Steam.
2. Main menu → **MODS**; accept the prompt about DLC being disabled and the game restarting.
3. The first entry into the mods menu runs a "configuring game data" pass of 5–15 minutes — not a hang. Thread 702075's opening post reports it may crash once and work after a relaunch.
4. Enable the VP mods the installer placed in MODS.
5. Press **NEXT**, never **Back**.
6. **Single Player** → **Set Up Game**.

CRITICAL — Back returns to the main menu and silently deactivates the mod set — the most common "I installed VP and nothing changed" report. The installer's finish screen says the same: enable all mods, click Next, not Back.

(2) Vox Populi	Requires (1) Community Patch
(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files	MUST be enabled on any EUI install, or VP will not function
(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch	Only for 43-civ variants
(4a) Squads for VP	Optional QoL – RTS-style control groups on Ctrl+number
(5) Modpack Maker for VP	Leave off for normal play; builds modpacks (\$10)

Check: the main menu lists active mods in the lower right. EUI working but no new units, luxuries, or advanced-setup options means the base game with EUI only — redo from the MODS menu without pressing Back.

7. Settings and stability

Setting	Single player	Multiplayer
Autosave frequency	1 turn	1 turn
Max autosaves	0 (unlimited)	500
Leader Scene Quality	Minimum	Minimum
Yield icons	Off from the Industrial era	Off from the Industrial era – every player must do it

The single-player figures are what the install thread and the bug-report form ask for; the modpack thread asks for 500 in multiplayer. Either way the aim is a save from the turn *before* a problem, which needs frequent autosaves that are not rotated away.

Late-game crashes are a memory problem, not a Vox Populi bug. Civ V is 32-bit, and the project attributes most late-game CTDs (crashes to desktop) to address-space exhaustion. Mitigations, most important first: Leader Scene Quality on Minimum; yield icons off from the Industrial era (or avoid zooming far out); standard or small maps; a lower in-game resolution — ultrawide and 4K panels are the demanding case.

Proton helps here: `PROTON_FORCE_LARGE_ADDRESS_AWARE` is **on by default**, giving the 32-bit executable a 4 GB address space instead of 2 GB. Leave it alone.

Early, random crashes are a different problem. ProtonDB reports tie them to thread count. Under Proton the reported fix is to pin the game to eight threads with the launch option `taskset -c 0-7 %command%`; one reporter instead raised `MaxSimultaneousThreads` in `$CIV5_DOCS/config.ini` (default 8) to what `nproc` prints, and another found that 24 stopped the game starting. Reports that edit that key under `~/.local/share/Aspyr` concern the native build; Proton never reads that file.

```
nproc
rg -n MaxSimultaneousThreads "$CIV5_DOCS/config.ini"
```

Check: compare the two numbers before changing anything.

Late-game turn times are AI-bound, not GPU-bound. Treat graphics settings as a memory lever rather than a frame-rate one, and cap the frame rate at the panel's refresh rate with V-Sync.

8. Adding other mods

Any mod that ships its own DLL is incompatible. VP replaces the Civ V DLL entirely, and the Community Patch cannot coexist with another DLL mod. Steam Workshop subscriptions do not reliably land in the right place under Proton. Download from CivFanatics or GitHub and extract manually. Mods go in `$CIV5_DOCS/MODS` — inside the prefix, beside the VP folders. After ANY mod change, delete `cache/` and `ModUserData/` before launching. Stale cache is the single most common reason mods look broken after a change. Filenames do not need lowercasing under Proton; that applies to the native build.

```
test -d "$CIV5_DOCS"; or echo "STOP - set the $2 variables first"
rm -rf "$CIV5_DOCS/cache" "$CIV5_DOCS/ModUserData"
```

Check the CivFanatics "MODS compatible with Vox Populi (VP)" thread first: VP reworks most systems, so mods that touch game components are often only partly compatible. Reported working under Proton: Community Events, Improved City View (Gazebo's version), most of WHoward's Pick'N'Mix, and Info Addict (extra patch needed with EUI) — though the modpack maintainer warns that Info Addict is known to crash from memory overflow (\$7).

9. Optional tuning

9.1 Community Patch options file

Open this file in your editor:

```
$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/NewCustomModOptions.xml
```

Rules from the file's own header: an option with a **"See also:"** comment must be enabled through its mod, not here; one listing **"Defines:"** or **"PostDefines:"** needs those defines verified first; anything else is enabled by changing Value from 0 to 1.

Each row carries a Class saying what kind of option it is, not how safe it is:

0	Data	Values consumed by other options
1	Bugfix	Unused – bugfixes are always on in the Community Patch
2	API	Extensions with no effect unless another mod uses them
3	Events	Game-core triggers – significant overhead even when unused
4	Minor	Limited gameplay changes
5	Moderate	Noticeable gameplay changes
6	Major	Significant gameplay changes

Leave Class 3 alone unless you need it: those run game-core triggers whether or not anything consumes them. Of the file's full option set — 29 API-class rows alone — these four are the ones most people want:

ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS	Steam achievements in modded single-player. Marked "FUNCTIONALITY NOT GUARANTEED" and it changes the savegame format – set it before a campaign, not during
DIPLO_DEBUG_MODE (+ ..._SETTING)	Reveals the AI's true opinion, approach and Congress voting; at setting 2 the AI accepts every Discuss request. The best window into how VP scores you
SQLITE_LOGGING CORE_DEBUGGING	Writes gameplay statistics to a queryable stats.db Extra game-core debugging; slows the game, leave off

Clear the cache after editing, and keep a copy — the installer rewrites these folders on every update.

Use ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS rather than the executable-patching method used for other modded Civ V setups. Map-type achievements are broken on the native Linux build regardless of mods, but work under Proton.

9.2 Back up before updating

```
set stamp (date +%Y%m%d)
set dest "$HOME/civ5-backup-$stamp"
mkdir -p "$dest"
rsync -a "$CIV5_DOCS/Saves" "$CIV5_DOCS/MODS" "$dest/"
```

Check: `ls "$dest"` prints MODS and Saves.

Saves live inside the Wine prefix, so a full prefix reset destroys them too.

10. Multiplayer

VP cannot be played in multiplayer through the MODS menu; it must be packaged as a modpack that loads automatically as a DLC.

Preferred — a prebuilt modpack. The CivFanatics modpack thread tracks current releases (5.4.6), including one generated on Linux under Proton. Extract so the modpack folder sits directly under `$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/`, then `rm -rf "$CIV5_DOCS/cache"`. Modpacks also work in single player and are easier to update than a mods-menu install.

Or build your own: enable (5) Modpack Maker for VP plus every mod to include → start or load a game → **Ctrl-Shift-M** → check `$CIV5_DOCS/Logs/Lua.log` for errors → exit → `rm -rf "$CIV5_DOCS/cache"` → relaunch and start from Single Player or Multiplayer, never the MODS menu.

Or let civ5vp-installer build one (§14).

Modpacks cannot be combined with mods activated through the MODS menu
 Every player must use byte-identical modpacks
 Every player must delete cache/ BEFORE EVERY LAUNCH, or the game will most likely crash after the first turn
 Do not hand-edit `Assets\DLC\VP_MODPACK` – rebuild instead
 Saves do not record which modpack was used; a mismatch crashes
 Multiplayer autosaves live in `Saves\multi\auto` – collect them for desync reports

Remove with `rm -rf "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK" "$CIV5_DOCS/cache"`.

An open upstream report, [Community-Patch-DLL #13349 \(2026-09-05\)](#), describes a multiplayer desync on 5.4.x that its reporter suspects lies in pathfinding. Check its state before starting a long multiplayer game.

MPPatch, which would allow modded multiplayer without modpacks, has had no release since December 2023, and a forum report describes crashes when combined with VP plus EUI. Modpacks remain the supported route.

11. Updating

Run the newer `Vox.Populi.<version>.exe` exactly as in Steps 6–7. It deletes the old mod folders and cache before writing; no manual cleanup. Take the §9.2 backup first if you have edited anything under MODS.

By the project's versioning rule, saves are compatible when only the third version component changes: 5.4.4 → 5.4.6 keeps them, 5.4.x → 5.5.0 does not.

WARNING — Steam's *Verify integrity of game files* restores the stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg`, which VP replaces to fix city-state audio (including the BNW bug where Cape Town uses Almaty's clip). Re-run the VP installer after any verify.

12. Uninstalling

Preferred, because it restores the stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg`: re-run the installer, choose **Uninstall all**, and point the Civilization V folder page at the same real install.

Manual fallback. Swap `rm -rf` for `ls -d` first and confirm the list resolves as expected.

```
test -d "$CIV5_DOCS"; and test -d "$CIV5_GAME"; or echo "STOP - set the $2 variables first"
rm -rf "$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(1) Community Patch" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(2) Vox Populi" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(4a) Squads for VP" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(5) Modpack Maker for VP" \
"$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/VPUI" \
"$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/UI_bc1" \
"$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK" \
"$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/cache" "$CIV5_DOCS/ModUserData" \
"$CIV5_DOCS/Text/VPUI_tips_en_us.xml"
```

Then verify game files in Steam to restore the stock Expansion2.Civ5Pkg. Verification leaves added files alone, hence the sound XML in the list above.

Full prefix reset (destroys in-prefix saves — back up first): `rm -rf "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930"`

13. Troubleshooting

Ordered by when the failure appears. **Setup and install:**

Symptom	Cause and fix
Steam: "disk write error" while it downloads the Windows depots (Step 1)	Steam client bug with case-mismatched depot folders (steam-for-linux #13406; the Civ V report is #13436), closed as completed 2026-07-27. Update Steam and retry; reporters created the folder the error names, in that exact case, under steamapps/downloading/8930.
Crashes on NVIDIA	Two May 2026 ProtonDB reports crash on drivers 580.142 and 595.71.05; one reverted the driver. A July report on 580.105.08 runs. Not a VP fault.
protontricks does not list Civ V	Prefix absent. Launch once via Proton (Step 3).
protontricks: "Found multiple Steam directories"	Native and Flatpak or Snap Steam both exist. Put STEAM_DIR=<the right one> in front of the command.
"Proton installation could not be found!"	Compat tool is a Steam Linux Runtime entry, not Proton.
Flatpak: "does not appear to have access to the following directories"	Re-select a real Proton build (Step 1).
"Invalid file magic number"	Run the flatpak override --user --filesystem=... command the message prints, then restart Protontricks (Step 4).
"Unknown option --no-bwrap"	Protontricks older than 1.12.0 cannot read the current appinfo.vdf. Upgrade, or use the Flatpak (§3).
"Unknown arg <verb>"	Protontricks options go BEFORE the app ID.
"command cabextract ... returned status 1"	Winetricks predates the verb; Debian and Ubuntu packages lag. Use the Flatpak, or upstream Winetricks.
"Cannot find cabextract"	cabextract trips over a symlink Proton created. Delete the symlink the error names, then re-run.
A Winetricks verb hangs	Install the cabextract package (§3 lists it).
"warning: 64-bit WINEPREFIX"	The thread-702075 report set PROTON_NO_FSYNC=1 in front of the command (Step 4); try that.
Wizard never appears	Expected. Civ V is 32-bit. Ignore.
"You don't have all required DLCs"	Wayland focus or a broken Proton build. Check other windows, then try Proton Experimental or proton-cachyos-slr.
"did not provide the correct path"	Missing DLC under the chosen path. Enable every DLC in Steam and re-run the Step 2 loop.
	Chosen folder has no Assets\DLC child. Point at the game root, not Assets or DLC.

In the game:

Symptom	Cause and fix
Crash during the first configuring game data pass VP absent from the in-game mod list	The thread-702075 opening post saw this once; relaunch and enter MODS again (§6). Documents page was changed; mods are outside the prefix. Re-run with the default Documents path.
Missing textures, broken UI	Civ V folder page pointed at a game tree inside the prefix. Re-run, or copy across per Step 8.
EUI works, no other VP features	Back was pressed in MODS, or (3a) is not enabled on an EUI install. Re-enable all mods, press NEXT.
Mods stale, duplicated or missing	rm -rf cache/ and ModUserData/ (§8). Then look for Workshop subscriptions sharing mod IDs, or a mod with its own DLL.
An rm -rf line returns at once and nothing changes CustomModOption change has no effect Still broken after all of the above	The \$2 variables are not set in this terminal. Run the four lines again, then repeat the command. Cache not cleared, or the option needed its defines. §9.1.
Random crashes early in a session	Minimal install – VP without EUI, no other mods – then add EUI, then other mods, one layer at a time.
Crash to desktop in the late game	Thread count (ProtonDB reports). Pin to eight threads with taskset, or align MaxSimultaneousThreads (§7). 32-bit address-space exhaustion. Apply §7 in order, and keep \$CIV5_GAME/crashlogs for a report (§15).
Crackling audio Multiplayer crashes after turn 1 DX9 starts despite choosing DX11 DX11 hangs after a few minutes	One ProtonDB report: PULSE_LATENCY_MSEC=60 %command%. Cache not cleared before launch by every player (§10). Proton report #8327, closed as not planned. Not a VP fault. A January 2026 ProtonDB report ran stable with the launch option -dx9; another saw gray screen areas under DX9.

14. Alternative installer

github.com/Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer — a single-file native Linux binary (Apache-2.0) that installs VP without Protontricks. It finds the Civ V folders itself (you can correct them), writes only to the game's MODS, DLC and Text folders and its cache, has a modpack mode, and its Uninstall button restores an unmodded game. Unofficial or in-development versions are compiled locally — about 1.1 GB of build tools once, roughly 5 GB in ~/.local/share/civ5vp-installer. Proton-only, like §1. Newer and less tested than the Protontricks route; a fallback if the Inno wizard misbehaves.

```
mkdir -p "$HOME/Downloads"
set -g CIV5VP_SUM a0b59eb445d23bc9a5206ec0f592a7f81c4cfd40a5f2e0d823737bacbd271baa
curl -fL -o "$HOME/Downloads/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64" \
  https://github.com/Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer/releases/download/v0.1.6/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64
echo "$CIV5VP_SUM $HOME/Downloads/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64" | sha256sum -c -
```

Check: the last line ends in OK; the digest is that of v0.1.6 (2026-09-15). Only then make the file executable and start it:

```
chmod +x "$HOME/Downloads/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64"
"$HOME/Downloads/civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64"
```

WARNING — Install release versions only. On 2026-08-26 the author advised against its "Compile the DLL myself" option, single player included: the compiler it currently uses probably drops loop checks from the C++ code, which can freeze the game.

Packs built by versions before 0.1.6 can show raw text keys for loading tips and EUI options (upstream issue #13364); rebuild and redistribute them with 0.1.6.

15. Bug reporting

Vox Populi bugs go to the project's GitHub issue tracker, not the forum; errors in this guide go to this repository's tracker. Upstream's bug form is the only route (blank issues are disabled). It requires the mod version and installed components — the setup type from Step 7 — and asks for three attachments:

Save from one turn before the problem	\$CIV5_DOCS/Saves – the reason for the autosave settings in \$7
Logs	\$CIV5_DOCS/Logs – useless unless logging was already on
Crash artifacts, when reporting a crash	\$CIV5_GAME/crashlogs for crashes.log and the .dmp, per the issue form. The minidump guide instead says dumps land beside the game executable as CvMiniDump_*.dmp – check both; the command below covers them.

Logging is off by default and must be on *before* the problem occurs. Enable it once per installation in \$CIV5_DOCS/config.ini: set ValidateGameDatabase, LoggingEnabled, MessageLog, AILog, AIPerfLog, BuilderAILog and PlayerAndCityAILogSplit to 1. (Upstream's docs name the folder "Civilization V"; it is "Civilization 5".) Collect logs *before* loading a game — most are erased on load.

```
cd "$CIV5_DOCS"; and zip -r ~/civ5-vp-logs.zip Logs
cd "$CIV5_GAME"; and zip -r ~/civ5-vp-crash.zip crashlogs
cd "$CIV5_GAME"; and find . -maxdepth 1 -name 'CvMiniDump_*.dmp' -exec zip ~/civ5-vp-crash.zip {} +
```

Dumps are not guaranteed under Proton: the DLL loads dbghelp.dll from the prefix's System32, so it depends on Wine's implementation. If none appears after a crash, say so in the report and attach the logs and save.

Turn logging back off when you are not chasing a bug; it rewrites a large directory continuously.

The project wiki adds guidance on writing a report, a full changelog, a Lua API reference, and a page on the group movement that (4a) Squads for VP builds on.

16. Command appendix

```
# CIV5_LIB: native Steam on CachyOS; other packagings in $3
set -g CIV5_LIB "$HOME/.local/share/Steam"
set -g CIV5_GAME "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V"
set -g CIV5_PFX "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/drive_c"
set -g CIV5_DOCS "$CIV5_PFX/users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/Sid Meier's Civilization 5"

sudo pacman -S --needed protontricks yad zenity ripgrep rsync zip

# [Steam] Compatibility > force a Proton build (not a Linux Runtime)
# [Steam] DLC > enable everything
# [Steam] Proton 10.0 or older only: launch option PROTON_SET_GAME_DRIVE=1 %command%
find "$CIV5_GAME" -maxdepth 1 -iname '*.exe'

for d in DLC_01 DLC_02 DLC_03 DLC_04 DLC_05 DLC_06 DLC_07 DLC_Deluxe Expansion Expansion2
do
    test -d "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/$d"; and echo "ok $d"; or echo "MISS $d"
end

# [Steam] launch once, reach the main menu, quit
ls "$CIV5_PFX"
ls "$CIV5_DOCS"
ls -l "$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/dosdevices"
protontricks --version
protontricks -s civilization
protontricks 8930 -q vcrun2008 corefonts
protontricks 8930 list-installed
```

```

mkdir -p "$HOME/Downloads"
set -g CIV5_SUM 31679423e55d7f64ba9693d8252d9e29f824fd9f8da043af547470068f98ba8a
curl -fL -o "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe" \
  https://github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/releases/download/Release-5.4.6/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe
echo "$CIV5_SUM $HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe" | sha256sum -c -

echo "Z:$CIV5_GAME" | tr / "\\\\"
# [Wizard] Documents page unchanged; Civ V folder browsed to S:\ or the Z:\ path above
protontricks-launch --appid 8930 "$HOME/Downloads/Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe"

ls "$CIV5_DOCS/MODS"
ls "$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC" | rg -i 'VPUI|UI_bc1'
ls "$CIV5_PFX/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V/Assets/DLC" 2>/dev/null

# [Game] MODS > enable the VP mods > NEXT (never Back) > Single Player
# [Game] Options > Leader Scene Quality: Minimum; autosave every 1 turn

```

17. Path reference

Wine prefix root	\$CIV5_PFX
Drive mappings	\$CIV5_LIB/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/dosdevices
Mods	\$CIV5_DOCS/MODS
CP options file	\$CIV5_DOCS/MODS/(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/ NewCustomModOptions.xml
Cache · per-mod user data	\$CIV5_DOCS/cache · \$CIV5_DOCS/ModUserData
Logs · logging switches	\$CIV5_DOCS/Logs · \$CIV5_DOCS/config.ini
Saves (single · multi)	\$CIV5_DOCS/Saves · \$CIV5_DOCS/Saves/multi/auto
EUI tooltip text	\$CIV5_DOCS/Text/VPUI_tips_en_us.xml
Real game install	\$CIV5_GAME
Crash artifacts	\$CIV5_GAME/crashlogs, and CvMiniDump_*.dmp beside the game executable in \$CIV5_GAME
VP UI · EUI · modpack	\$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/VPUI · UI_bc1 · VP_MODPACK
Replaced BNW package	\$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Expansion2.Civ5Pkg
Added city-state sound XML	\$CIV5_GAME/Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Sounds/XML/ MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml
Steam library, other packagings	\$3, second table
civ5vp-installer data	~/.local/share/civ5vp-installer
Phantom tree (stays empty)	\$CIV5_PFX/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/ Sid Meier's Civilization V

18. Sources

The Vox Populi source tree and releases:

Installer behavior: two-path wizard, setup types, DLC gate, cache and legacy-folder deletion, mod folders rewritten on install, Uninstallable=no, Expansion2.Civ5Pkg swap, Inno Setup, savegame compatibility rule, Installer v1.2 requirement list Mod dependencies, EUI rules, VPUI/UI_bcl destinations, audio rationale; Squads is QoL CustomModOptions rules and toggles 1.0.3.279 + all DLC; logging keys; minidumps Option Class legend and the Events overhead Minidump filename pattern, location beside the executable, dbghelp.dll dependency Blank issues disabled; required fields; the three attachments; crashlogs path; the 0/1 autosave rationale Report-writing guidance, Lua API, group movement page 5.4.6 stable, asset name, sha256 Game-core DLL imports MSVCR90 and MSVCP90 Modpack: Ctrl-Shift-M, cache rules, removal	LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL – VPSetupData.iss, scripts/release.py, Opener.rtf (1)/(2)/(3a) INSTRUCTIONS.txt and MANUAL INSTALL.txt; (4a) Squads modinfo (1) Community Patch/Database Changes/NewCustomModOptions.xml VP README.md, DEVELOPMENT.md, docs/minidumps.md NewCustomModOptions.xml header docs/minidumps.md .github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE/bug_report_v5.yml and config.yml Community-Patch-DLL wiki GitHub releases + release feed, 2026-08-31; still the newest release on 2026-09-19 CvGameCore_Expansion2.dll, both 5.4.6 variants, PE import table (5) Modpack Maker modinfo, ModpackMaker.lua
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Community threads and third-party projects:

Prebuilt modpacks incl. Linux/Proton build; MP autosave and log-collection guidance; open 5.4.x desync report; Info Addict memory warning Late-game CTD from 32-bit memory; Leader Scene Quality, yield icons, maps and resolution; beta vs stable naming Autosave recommendation; Workshop and DLL conflicts; don't delete after the installer; minimal-install triage; compatibility list Linux mod handling: DLL exclusivity, Workshop unreliability under Proton, MODS location, cache + ModUserData, known-good mods; Documents-path warning; launch first; first configure pass may crash once Runtime-library report and its variables; Debian/Ubuntu Steam path in use Achievements via VP's own option; native Linux map-achievement breakage Steam Linux Runtime breaks Protontricks Alternative installer: 0.1.6, asset, sha256, data dir, local-build warning, text-key bug MPPatch last release Dec 2023 Original copy-the-Assets workaround	CivFanatics modpack thread 685164; posts #721 (2026-09-05) and #732 (2026-09-19) for the last two, with Community-Patch-DLL issue #13349 CivFanatics "Welcome to the Community Patch sub – Start Here" thread 701813 CivFanatics "What is Vox Populi – How To Install" thread 528034; "MODS compatible with Vox Populi" thread 542679 CivFanatics thread 702075 (schubman, 2026-02-13 → 2026-03-19), now stickied Thread 702075 page 2, posts #21–#23 (2026-09-13 → 2026-09-16) bmaupin/civ5-cheevos-with-mods README, citing Community-Patch-DLL issue #12965 TeaDrinkingProgrammer guide issue #3 Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer README, CHANGELOG, v0.1.6 assets; CivFanatics thread 704249; Community-Patch-DLL #13364 Lymia/MPPatch release feed, 2026-09-19 TeaDrinkingProgrammer GitHub guide
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Linux, Proton and packaging:

LARGE_ADDRESS_AWARE default; GAME_DRIVE and its 11.0 default; fsync switch; DX9/DX11 launch report

Protontricks CLI, option order, prefix warning, Flatpak overrides and aliases, distro-package advice, cabextract error 1.12.0 appinfo.vdf floor; Steam directory discovery incl. Flatpak, Snap, STEAM_DIR; WINEPREFIX override; fsync default; the not-Proton and Flatpak-access messages vcrun2008 and corefonts contents, skip if installed, -q, cabextract requirement WINE_DISABLE_NICE read nowhere

Package versions and repos
ripgrep is part of a stock CachyOS install
Ubuntu, Debian and Fedora package names, versions and Steam install steps; NVIDIA 32-bit libraries on Debian

Steam default dir and ~/.steam/root
Debian/Ubuntu Steam directory

Steam disk write error on case-mismatched depot folders
Early-crash thread fix; NVIDIA, DX9/DX11 and audio reports

ValveSoftware/Proton README and proton script – proton_9.0, 10.0, 11.0 and experimental_11.0; Proton issue #8327
Matoking/protontricks README + TROUBLESHOOTING.md; flathub manifest docs

protontricks 1.14.1 CHANGELOG.md, steam.py, util.py, cli/command.py, gui.py, data/scripts/wine_launch.sh

Winetricks/winetricks src/winetricks (20260125)
ValveSoftware/wine proton_11.0 and CachyOS/wine-cachyos source trees
archlinux.org package DB; mirror.cachyos.org
CachyOS/cachyos-calamares netinstall.yaml
packages.ubuntu.com, Launchpad;
packages.debian.org, sources.debian.org;
Repology (Fedora); Debian wiki: Steam as indexed, and a Debian 12 write-up that follows it; RPM Fusion command as quoted by Fedora guides; Flathub setup pages
Arch Wiki: Steam
steam-installer 1.0.0.85 source:
debian/steam-installer.README.Debian,
debian/scripts/steam.in; thread 702075 #22
ValveSoftware/steam-for-linux #13406, #13436
ProtonDB public data export, 2026-09-01:
196 reports for app 8930

19. Limits

- **Thread 702075 page 1 cannot be fetched verbatim** (metadata only), so its opening post is known from indexed excerpts; page 2 was read in full, last on 2026-09-19. Structural facts come from the Vox Populi source tree, hence the different Assets/DLC folder name and the avoidable copy step.
- **The S: default was read from Proton's source, not observed**; the Step 1 check settles it, and Z: always works.
- **The runtime-library step rests on one forum report and the DLL's import table**; it was not reproduced on a clean prefix. It is cheap, and Winetricks skips what is installed.
- **§3 was checked against package indexes and upstream documentation, not run** on any of those systems; the Protontricks 1.12.0 floor is what matters.
- **ProtonDB's page needs JavaScript**, so its public data export (2026-09-01) was read instead; the §7 and §13 items from it are community reports, not tested fixes.
- **§9.1 toggles were read from the source file, not exercised**. ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS is marked "functionality not guaranteed" upstream and changes the savegame format.
- **Upstream disagrees with itself on where crash dumps land** — the issue form says crashlogs, the minidump guide says beside the game executable. Both are covered.
- **Written against 5.4.6**. Wizard page order and setup-type names have been stable but are not guaranteed; the sha256 is for 5.4.6 only.
- **Untested paths**: Flatpak and Snap Steam (procedure holds, paths move), the 43-civ variants, MPPatch, and civ5vp-installer's local DLL build.